



Plants for patios, balconies, and windowsills

While most colorful bedding plants require sun to bloom, shady patio and balcony displays can also be stunning displays of blooms and foliage.

Many annuals will flower in light shade, but if your area is darker, choose fuchsia, impatiens, and wishbone flower for summerlong displays. For fall and winter troughs on windowsills, include some young shrubs, such as skimmia and wintergreen, which produce pretty buds and berries and can be planted in pots of their own when they outgrow their first home; shrubs can be kept small by clipping. In fall, squeeze daffodil and grape hyacinth bulbs between the shrubs for a burst of color in early spring. If you have space, add a few large shrubs in bold containers to lend permanent structure to your design.



PERENNIAL SMALL

Begonia Olympia Series

WAX BEGONIA This is an evergreen perennial, often sold as annual summer bedding. It produces glossy green leaves and small white, pink, or red flowers with golden eyes. Plant it in containers and baskets of all-purpose potting soil.

↔ 10in (25cm)

☀ Z10–11



PERENNIAL SMALL

Bellis perennis

ENGLISH DAISY This evergreen perennial bears rosettes of spoon-shaped dark green leaves and white daisies in late spring. Tasso Series (above) has pink, white, or red, pompomlike flowers. Plant in containers, baskets, and windowboxes in potting mix.

↔ 8in (20cm)

☀ Z4–8



ANNUAL/BIENNIAL MEDIUM

Calendula officinalis

POT MARIGOLD A bushy annual with lance-shaped, pale green aromatic leaves and daisy-like single or double flowers in shades of yellow and orange from spring to fall. Sow seeds directly in containers of all-purpose potting soil.

↔ 24in (60cm)



SHRUB LARGE

Camellia x williamsii

CAMELLIA This evergreen shrub has oval, pointed, glossy bright green leaves and, in spring, large clusters of pink or white blooms. Varieties include 'Donation' (above) with pink semidouble flowers. Plant it in large pots of acidic soil mix.

↔ 15ft (5m) ↔ 8ft (2.5m)

☀ Z7–9



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Carex 'Ice Dance'

SEDGE An evergreen perennial sedge, featuring mounds of grassy green leaves, with creamy white margins and small white spring flowers. Plant it in containers and windowboxes in soil-based potting mix; water well.

↔ 24in (60cm) ↔ 30in (75cm)

☀ Z5–9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Carex oshimensis

JAPANESE SEDGE This evergreen perennial has glossy, arching, cream-striped dark green leaves and insignificant flower spikes in summer. Yellow-striped 'Evergold' (above) gives bright winter interest in containers and windowboxes in soil-based potting mix.

↔ 8in (20cm)

☀ Z5–9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Carex siderosticha

BROAD-LEAVED SEDGE A deciduous or semievergreen perennial with arching, grassy green leaves and small, brown spring-flower spikes. Plant in containers or baskets of soil-based potting mix. 'Variegata' (above) has cream-edged foliage.

↔ 12in (30cm) ↔ 16in (40cm)

☀ Z5–9



SHRUB MEDIUM

Clethra alnifolia

SUMMERSWEET This deciduous shrub has oval, serrated midgreen leaves. From late summer to early fall, it produces spikes of fragrant, bell-shaped white flowers. Plant it in a large pot of acidic soil mix in full or part shade.

↔ 8ft (2.5m)

☀ Z3–9 (N)



BULB SMALL

Cyclamen coum

HARDY CYCLAMEN A dwarf perennial bulb with rounded, silver-marbled dark green leaves and deep pink blooms with a purple blotch at the base of each petal in late winter. Goes dormant in summer heat. Plant in soil-based potting mix with added grit.

↔ 4in (10cm)

☀ (I) Z5–9